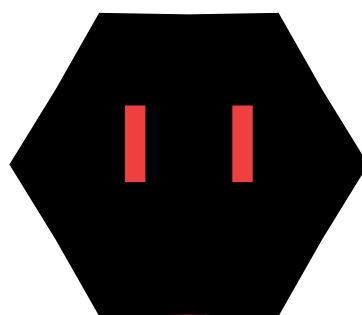




\$11.78 billion

The amount India is likely to spend on AI in 2025, per PwC



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impact from digital technologies in general, and from AI in particular. “We use AI for almost all operations of our chain of hospitals, and it has indeed transformed the business in a big way in the past few years,” says Dr Ashutosh Raghuvanshi, Managing Director and CEO of Fortis Healthcare. Some of the things that AI has done for Fortis include management of electronic health records (EHRs), improving the efficiency of patient operational flow, and hospital data management.

For pharmaceutical companies, the impact has been bigger. Sun Pharma has adopted a range of technologies, including AI and ML, to improve drug discovery, reduce time-to-market, and optimise clinical trials. Similarly, Cipla has invested heavily in AI and cloud computing to improve its supply chain management and product development. Further, Dr. Reddy’s Laboratories has adopted AI and ML to improve its drug discovery and clinical trial processes.

“India has emerged as the world’s largest generic drug supplier by volume, contributing 20 per cent of the

total pharmaceutical exports. It satisfies 50 per cent of the global demand for vaccines post-pandemic. The phenomenal growth in the country’s pharmaceuticals industry is backed by technological innovation and investments in newer operation mechanisms, thus providing a huge opportunity for global tech companies to partner and collaborate with the pharma sector,” says Debashish Roy, Director and Head-Digital Innovation at global pharma giant Pfizer.

The opportunity is big. A PwC report released this March says that AI expenditure in India is expected to reach \$11.78 billion by the end of 2025, and by 2035, AI expenditure is expected to contribute \$1 trillion to the Indian economy.

“Standardisation and open access to healthcare data, as well as the usage of AI on that data, have increased by leaps and bounds,” says Ram Deshpande, Partner-Technology Consulting at EY India. “Avenues for AI adoption today range from personalised self-assisted care to state-led health initiatives, aided by cutting-